

# THE OTHER ONE

## *Production & Cinematography Report for an In-Game Cutscene*

GAME 326 — Cinematography for Games | Final Project  
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This document accompanies the rendered cutscene *CutsceneFinal.mp4* and completes the production phase of the project whose pre-production materials—premise, logline, synopsis, script, sixteen-shot script, and storyboard—were submitted separately. It restates the game-design context, then provides a detailed breakdown of how each of the Five C's of Cinematography was applied across the finished sequence, illustrated with frames captured directly from the final render. A short account of the production workflow and credits closes the document.

## 1. Game Design Context

The Other One is an in-game cutscene belonging to *Awakening*, a first-person psychological science-fiction horror game set within the corridors of a clandestine subterranean research facility. The visual style is photorealistic with a deliberately desaturated, chiaroscuro-driven aesthetic that combines sterile institutional surfaces with the residual decay of an abandoned space. Core mechanics privilege slow exploration, environmental observation, and audio-driven navigation, while combat is minimal and stealth-adjacent. The narrative concerns a memory-stripped test subject who gradually reconstructs fragments of his identity by traversing the facility. This cutscene occurs roughly one-third into the game as a mid-game revelation: after surviving the opening corridors and beginning to question the nature of the facility, the protagonist encounters a sealed laboratory containing another subject identical to himself. The sequence marks the narrative pivot at which existential confusion crystallises into a specific, devastating realisation—that the protagonist is one of many.

## 2. Sequence Structure

The finished cutscene runs approximately 85 seconds at 1920×1080 and is constructed from sixteen shots organised into three dramatic movements. The **Approach** (Shots 1–4) uses objective third-person camerawork to establish the corridor and track the protagonist toward the door. The **Discovery** (Shots 5–7) shifts to a first-person crouch and lean that reveals the laboratory and the identical body within. The **Recognition and Aftermath** (Shots 8–16) delivers a Vertigo-style dolly zoom, a six-flash collision montage, and a high-wide closing composition that isolates the protagonist in a corridor washed crimson. Hard cuts dominate the edit; the only dissolve introduces the first-person shift, and the sole fade closes the sequence to black.

## Movement Map

| Movement    | Shots                                   | Function                                                                                    |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Approach    | 01–04 (objective, 3rd person)           | Establish space, scale and the protagonist's vulnerability against oppressive architecture. |
| Discovery   | 05–07 (first person → objective CU)     | Subjective entry into the laboratory; focus-pull reveal resolving onto the identical face.  |
| Recognition | 08–16 (dolly, flash montage, high wide) | Identity collapse, fragmented memory, alarm, and terminal isolation.                        |

## 3. Application of the Five C's of Cinematography

The five principles were not treated as a checklist but as interlocking tools, each assigned to the dramatic beats where it could do the most narrative work. The following sections isolate each principle, identify the key moments where it operates, and present a representative frame from the final render.

### 3.1 Camera Angles

Angle is used throughout to express the gap between how the protagonist appears and how powerless he actually is. In Shot 2 the camera sits near floor height and pushes in as he advances, so that he grows in frame and is haloed by the doorway light behind him. The low angle conventionally signals dominance, but here it is *ironic*: it inflates a psychologically fragile, memory-stripped figure, priming the audience for the collapse to come. The principle is then inverted at the climax. Shot 16 lifts the camera to a high, wide vantage that shrinks the protagonist to a small silhouette in the lower third of a crimson corridor. The journey from an inflating low angle to a diminishing high angle traces the character's arc—from false self-possession to the recognition that he is replaceable.



*Shot 2 — ironic low-angle push-in; the doorway light forms a halo as the subject fills the frame.*



*Shot 16 — terminal high-wide; the same character is reduced to a small silhouette in a red-washed corridor.*

### 3.2 Continuity

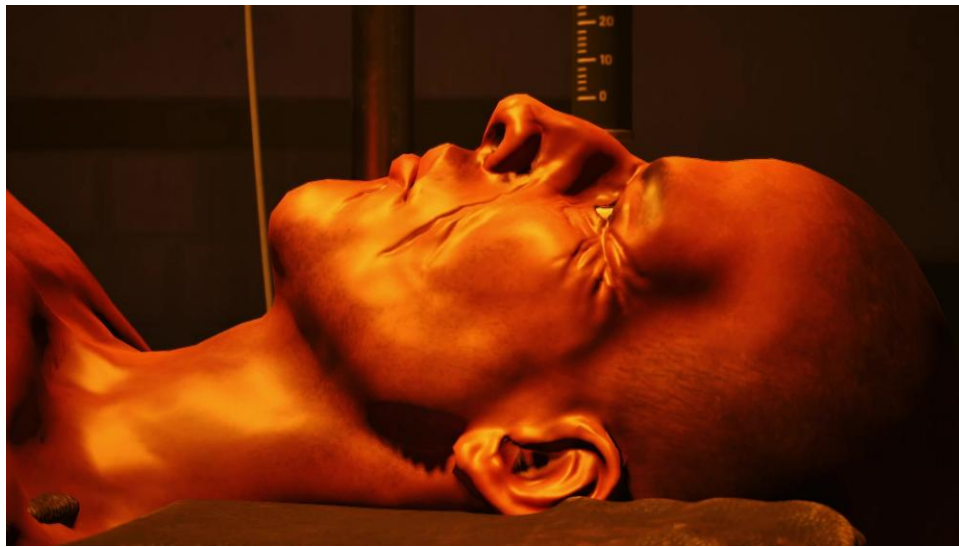
Continuity holds the sequence together across a deliberately disorienting structure. Spatial logic is preserved as the perspective moves from objective third person (Shots 1–4) into first person at the threshold (Shot 5) and back to objective coverage after the montage (Shot 15): the doorway, the surgical table and the warm spill of light remain consistently placed, so the audience never loses the geography even as the point of view shifts. The most demanding continuity work is the *match cut across time* in Shot 14, where the final memory flash returns to the body on the table in exactly the framing of Shot 7. Because the present-day close-up (Shot 14) is a duplicate of the earlier objective close-up, the past and the present collapse into a single, continuous image—the cut reads as recognition rather than as a jump. The focus-pull in Shot 6, ramping from a blurred foreground to a sharp resolution on the face, likewise maintains subjective continuity by simulating the dilation of attention.



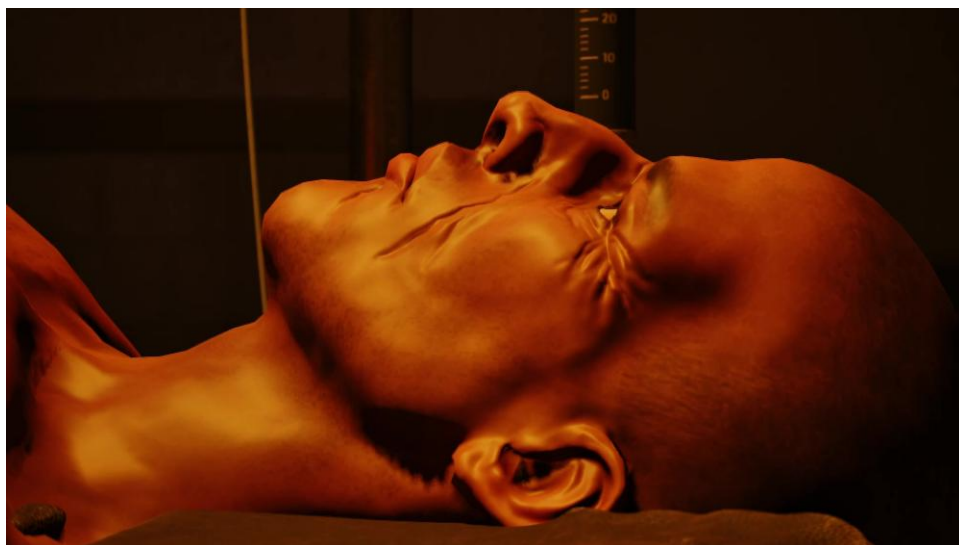
*Shot 5–6 — first-person continuation; the doorframe frames the laboratory and the focus resolves onto the body within.*

### 3.3 Cutting

Cutting governs the pacing across three registers. The approach is cut slowly, in long held shots, to build dread; the discovery tightens; and the recognition detonates. The centrepiece is the six-flash *collision montage* (Shots 9–14), an Eisensteinian sequence of two-to-four-frame fragments separated by black. The flashes accelerate—black gaps shorten from two frames to one as the montage climbs—so that the rhythm itself tightens toward the climax. Overexposure was applied per fragment in grading (+10, +8, +12 and a peak +15 on the final MEGA flash), while Shots 10 and 12 were deliberately left at normal exposure to provide legible, tactile beats among the white bursts. The montage ends on a hard *smash cut* from the brightest flash directly into the still, red corridor of Shot 15, the abrupt tonal reversal landing the shock. Elsewhere the dolly zoom (Shot 8) is held as a single continuous take, deliberately resisting the cut so that the audience is forced to dwell inside the moment of recognition.



*Shot 8 — the Vertigo dolly zoom is held as one continuous take before the montage erupts.*



*Shot 12 — a normally exposed fragment (the dilated eye) anchors the montage between overexposed bursts.*

### 3.4 Close-ups

Close-ups carry the emotional and informational weight of the sequence. The extreme close-up of the hand on the door handle (Shot 4) makes the threshold tactile and prepares the perspectival shift; the dilated-eye fragment (Shot 12) renders helplessness in a single image. The decisive close-up is Shot 7, the chiaroscuro profile of the body on the table. Lit hard from one side by the surgical lamp and left in deep shadow on the other, the shot withholds and then exposes the face—the moment the audience, with the protagonist, registers that it is his own. Strong directional lighting turns a simple close-up into the dramatic hinge of the entire cutscene.



*Shot 7 — chiaroscuro close-up of the identical body; warm key light against deep shadow stages the recognition.*

### 3.5 Composition

Composition is built on intention in every frame. The opening wide (Shot 1) uses the corridor's converging lines to lead the eye to the distant, glowing doorway, while placing the small figure low in the frame to establish the disproportion between character and architecture. The first-person reveal (Shot 5) uses a *frame within a frame*, the doorframe bracketing the laboratory interior and partially obscuring vision to mimic a cautious lean. Colour is itself compositional: the cool, desaturated approach is set against the warm gold of the discovery, and both are overrun by the crimson wash of the aftermath, so that each movement is legible by palette alone. The closing frame (Shot 16) places the protagonist on a lower-third intersection, lets red dominate the upper frame, and allows the doorway's warm light to fall as a single bright shape on the floor—a last, unreachable window onto the truth he cannot unsee.





*Shot 3 — rim light and left-side negative space compose tension around the listening profile.*



*Shot 15 — warm doorway against the throbbing red alarm: past warmth set compositionally against present threat.*

## 4. Production Workflow

All sixteen shots were staged and rendered in Unreal Engine 5.5 using the Sequencer and a Cine Camera Actor, with the environment built from the Modular Hospital asset pack and the character driven by Mixamo animation. Cameras were hand-placed per shot. The dolly zoom (Shot 8) was achieved by animating focal length from 50 mm to 100 mm while tracking the camera backward and ramping manual focus to match, with Cubic (Auto) interpolation for organic motion; the framing keeps the subject's scale broadly constant while the background warps. The final rise (Shot 16) likewise uses Cubic interpolation, while the flash fragments and hard cuts rely on per-shot static framing assembled in the edit.

Editing, the collision montage, exposure work, and colour grading were completed in DaVinci Resolve. The grade reinforces the three-movement palette—cool approach, warm discovery, crimson aftermath—so that time and place read through colour. The flash montage was cut frame-by-frame (4–4–5–4–5–5 frames with shortening black gaps), and exposure was lifted per fragment to produce the white-out bursts. Ambient drone, cinematic bass impacts synchronised to each flash, and a pulsing alarm in the final movement were added on the audio timeline; levels were balanced to a roughly –19 dB average with peaks held below clipping.

### Planned vs. Realised — Notable Production Decisions

| Element             | Planned                             | Realised                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Dolly zoom (Shot 8) | 100 mm → 50 mm with backward track. | Re-derived as 50 mm → 100 mm with backward dolly so the subject stays scale-constant while the world compresses—the correct Vertigo relationship for an inward, claustrophobic read.                                 |
| Stumble (Shot 15)   | Mixamo stumble-back animation.      | Stumble unavailable; reframed as a held, frozen idle against the wall, supported by a slow push-in and a throbbing red light—shifting the beat from panic to paralysis, which suits the script's "he can't move."    |
| Past face (Shot 13) | Distinct fearful expression.        | The character rig offered no facial blendshapes; the past self was differentiated instead through a $\frac{3}{4}$ -front low angle and cooler, even lighting, set against the warm side-profile of the present body. |

## 5. Credits

**Direction, cinematography, editing, grading, and sound design:** Kaan Eskikalıcı.

**Tools:** Unreal Engine 5.5 (Sequencer, Cine Camera Actor, Post Process Volume); DaVinci Resolve (edit, colour, Fairlight); Modular Hospital asset pack (Fab); Mixamo character animation; Freesound.org / Pixabay audio.